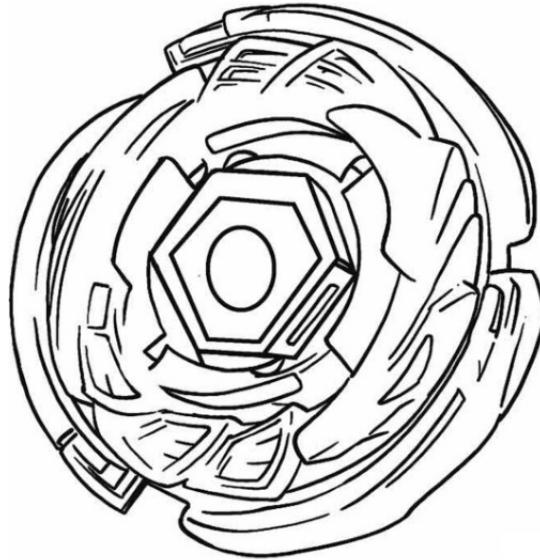




SPIN TOP

Written by

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FADE IN

1 PROLOGUE

Spin Top is a game between two or more players that focused on kids who battled each other using customizable dreidel-like toys. Some parts were illegal, but when you're in the dish, everything is fair game. This was Brian's childhood.

2 EXT. THE PARK - DAY

THE BOYS (BRIAN, RAV, AND CHIDDY) all crowded under a shady tree after exploring the city. They bought ice cream on the way back. They all live near the park.

BRIAN

You know in commercials, this stuff would be mashed potatoes?

CHIDDY

Word?

RAV

Yeah isn't it cause it doesn't melt under those lights?

BRIAN

Nah, I'm pretty sure ice cream just doesn't look like ice cream. Kinda like how cows don't look like cows on film, and you gotta use horses.

RAV

Dang, that's crazy, But how do-

RAV is cut off by loud yelling noises from a group of kids.

THE BOYS notice a crowd of youngsters swarmed around a bench. They're all yelling and screaming at something that seems like it's fighting to the death.

RAV

Ayo, what's going on?

CHIDDY

Probably lame kids stuff.

THE BOYS walk closer to get a better look, they are towering over these kids who all average a height of at most 5'2".

CHIDDY
Bro, is that Spin Top?

A group of youngsters is seen playing Spin Top in a frisbee smothered in mud.

CHIDDY CONT.
They really plastic now after that lawsuit.

RAV
Oh yeah, the one where it took out that kid's eye.

CHIDDY
(smug)
Yeahhh, Spin Tops for babies though.

RAV
Yea, Spin Top is pretty lame.

CHIDDY
But look, there's a tournament tomorrow.

CHIDDY points at a poster hanging near the bench stating there is a Spin Top tournament for a chance to win THE POWER GLOVE.

CHIDDY CONT.
Yo Brian, you remember when we used to play this back in middle school?

BRIAN doesn't respond.

CHIDDY CONT.
(his voice slowly becoming muffled as BRIAN's thoughts overtake him)
Brian...Brian...Brian...

BRIAN still doesn't respond and stares straight into the frisbee. He gets a traumatic flashback of a childhood memory.

3 INT. - MIDDLE SCHOOL BAND ROOM - DAY - FLASHBACK

BRIAN and CHIDDY as middle schoolers playing Spin Top with a group of kids after school. Every Spin Top is METAL.

COOL KID
Winner gets this LUNCHABLES BOX.

COOL KID is holding the DESSERT LUNCHABLES SET high above his head which contained the almighty Treatza.

CHIDDY

Bro, they don't even make those anymore.

BRIAN

I heard the Treatza takes like if a Unicorn and an Italian had a baby and you can you eat it. But after I win, I'm straight munching it in front of all you suckas.

A voice from afar joins the conversation.

COOL KID

You really think you'll win? Your top is trash! I bet I can beat you with my eyes closed.

BRIAN

Oh bet? Bet?! Let's run it right now then!

They line their Spin Tops in the dish. COOL KID, owning a better-looking Spin Top, knocks BRIAN's out, breaking it.

COOL KID, wearing a SILVER GLOVE, pushes BRIAN out of the group.

The crowd laughs. BRIAN tears up a little, he picks up his disassembled Spin Top parts and leaves out of sight. CHIDDY stares helplessly as BRIAN leaves the room.

4 EXT. THE PARK - DAY

BRIAN runs home, vengeance on his mind.

BRIAN

Wait...here...

BRIAN bikes off before CHIDDY or RAV has time to respond.

RAV

He's not coming back, is he?

CHIDDY

(sigh)

No, I'll go after him.

5 INT. - BRIAN'S ROOM - DAY

BRIAN bikes home since they don't live far.

BRIAN'S MOM
Back already?

BRIAN ignores the greeting and runs straight to his room, slamming the door. He opens his wardrobe, pulls out a little black box embossed with the word 'MEMORIES.' BRIAN opens it. A small glow emits from the box. BRIAN just stares at it, transfixed. He pulls out the Spin Top from his childhood and blows the dust off of it.

In the distance, CHIDDY and BRIAN's MOM are heard conversing in the kitchen. Shortly, CHIDDY is seen knocking on BRIAN's door. CHIDDY sees the Spin Top in BRIAN's hand and immediately understands.

CHIDDY
Oh...

BRIAN
I have to be in that tournament tomorrow.

CHIDDY
(sigh)
Bro, why? We all agreed that Spin Top is for babies.

BRIAN
I just, really want that glove.

You can tell BRIAN is lying. He plans to demolish all the plastic Spin Tops with his metal one in an attempt to feel closure to this horrible memory.

CHIDDY
(groans)
You really wanna risk your dignity where you, a grown man, are playing against literal 8 year-olds just to win some glove that doesn't even work half the time? That's weak, bro.

BRIAN
(speechless)
I'm getting, like, very sick of people trying to tell me how to live my life.

CHIDDY

It is what it is, bro. Imma rock with you regardless though, period.

BRIAN

You don't think I'll lose right?

CHIDDY

Ehhhh...

BRIAN stares at him disappointed.

CHIDDY CONT.

I'm sorry, you were pretty lame when we were playing with those in middle school.

BRIAN

I need you to train me man. You were up there with the cool kids. Surely you know some like ancient techniques.

CHIDDY

Sorry dude, but when it comes to Spin Top, you're gonna have to do some old-fashioned hard work. Call up Rav, he's always in his home gym.

They nod at each other and head over to RAV's house.

6 EXT. RAV'S GARAGE - DAY

RAV is seen lifting weights in his garage.

BRIAN AND CHIDDY

RAV, RAV, RAV, RAV, RAV!!

RAV

(annoyed)

What?

BRIAN

I need you to train me for the Spin Top tournament tomorrow.

RAV

(snickering)

Bro, what? Didn't we say Spin Top is for babies?

CHIDDY shrugs, indicating that he already tried to convince

BRIAN.

BRIAN
It's not for babies!

RAV
Okay, whatever. If you really wanna do this, it's gonna take hard work and dedication.

BRIAN agrees.

7 EXT. RAV'S GARAGE - MONTAGE - EVENING THROUGH SUNSET

BRIAN working out as CHIDDY and RAV coaches him. Hi-tempo electronic music plays.

BRIAN gives his first spin but the Spin Top quickly stops. RAV and CHIDDY shake their heads in disappointment.

RAV is pushing BRIAN down for a full pushup, BRIAN is shown to be exhausted but still motivated.

CHIDDY is counting BRIAN's bicep curls, spit flying everywhere.

RAV, stopwatch in hand, is shown counting BRIAN doing jumping jacks.

CHIDDY is jogging behind BRIAN towards the sunset as they become smaller and smaller silhouettes. This looks like a scene straight from 'ROCKY.'

BRIAN launches his Spin Top & it spins... and spins... and spins. RAV and CHIDDY shake their heads in approval.

8 EXT. - THE PARK - NOON

New day, day of the tournament, banners up, crowd cheering. BRIAN in a tracksuit stretching at a bench. RAV and CHIDDY wearing mirrored aviator sunglasses, looking on at BRIAN.

RAV
You think he can win?

CHIDDY
He's the only one with a metal Spin Top. He basically won by default.

The crowd gets louder as the players get ready.

Then...a man exits a vehicle. His face and body hid under a dark cloak but you can tell he isn't the same age as these youngsters but rather closer to the age of THE BOYS. One hand remains exposed as he shuts the car door, there you can see him wearing a SILVER GLOVE.

The crowd gasps and a collective chatter spread across the group all muttering his name, 'THE CHAMPION.'

BRIAN
Dude, you're so-

THE CHAMPION pushes past BRIAN.

BRIAN recognizes the silver glove when it makes contact with his shoulder. It hits him that this was the COOL KID in middle school.

BRIAN CONT.
It was you. You're the kid who made my
life miserable.

THE CHAMPION
I make a lot of people's lives
miserable kid.

THE CHAMPION pulls back to show the inside of his cloak. There, you see about 10 broken PLASTIC and METAL Spin Tops meticulously showcased to show his kills kind of like when 'Killmonger' revealed his scars for each of his victims.

The crowd gasps again.

BRIAN
You embarrassed me in front of
everybody, all I wanted was to win
that Treatza.

THE CHAMPION
(surprised)
Wait, you're Brian?! Dude, you were so
lame in middle school. But seriously,
this tournament is going to be so
boring.

BRIAN
Oh yeah? Is it more boring than my
fist in your face?

THE CHAMPION
I don't know, is it more boring MY

first in YOUR face! You TURD!

BRIAN
NO, YOU'RE A TURD!

THE CHAMPION
NO, YOU'RE a TURD!

BRIAN and THE CHAMPION start strangling each other, wrestling on the ground, but still call each other turds.

REFEREE
Alright, alright! Break it up you two!
In this tournament, we will play best
of five. The winner will get to take
home THE POWER GLOVE.

A podium slowly emerges from the ground, a cloud of steam covering the base, and standing proudly is THE POWER GLOVE.

REFEREE CONT.
Players to your stations!

9 EXT. - THE PARK - DAY - MONTAGE

BRIAN and THE CHAMPION move up the ranks of the tournament with ease blowing every PLASTIC Spin Top out of the park. Hi-tempo rock music plays.

Some are stopping earlier.

Some are getting launched out of the dish.

Some are just straight-up exploding on impact.

The METAL Spin Tops are clearly superior to the PLASTIC ones no matter how good they are.

10 EXT. - THE PARK - DAY

It's now the final round of the tournament.

THE CHAMPION
Well, well, well...I didn't think you
would make it this far.

BRIAN
Pssh...my matchups were easy. Your
opponents let them beat you because
they felt bad about much of a loser
you are.

The crowd 'oos' and 'awes' after each exchange of dialogue.

THE CHAMPION
(a little butthurt)
That doesn't even make any sense bro.

BRIAN
You don't make sense!

Just like before, they strangle each other wrestling on the ground exchanging words until the referee breaks them apart.

REFEREE
Break it up! Alright! You already know the rules, best of five except this round will be **to the death**.

The crowd gasps in horror.

CHIDDY
Wait, wait, wait... you said to the death?

THE CHAMPION laughs menacingly.

THE CHAMPION
The game has changed old man.

RAV
Brian, don't do it. This isn't worth it.

BRIAN contemplates his decision for a second.

BRIAN
Trust me, I got this.

BRIAN and THE CHAMPION take position on either end of a huge Spin Top dish. Round one is about to commence.

BRIAN and THE CHAMPION release their Spin Tops. Sparks fly everywhere as the two METAL Spin Tops collide. The crowd, especially the 8 year-olds, are in awe since they have never seen this before.

BRIAN wins the first round and the crowd erupts in a cheer. You can see THE CHAMPION getting a little nervous but keeps his cool.

They ready for the second round, which BRIAN wins but just barely. This makes game point for BRIAN. THE CHAMPION grows

furious and retaliates his anger onto the crowd.

The third round starts and THE CHAMPION wins this. The crowd boos but THE CHAMPION ignores.

The fourth round starts. BRIAN was about to win the tournament as he sees the CHAMPION's Spin Top start to lose momentum, but all of a sudden, he starts pressing buttons on his silver glove.

11 EXT. THE PARK - DAY BUT NOW WITH VERY HARSH WEATHER

The wind picks up. Lightning strikes causing the crowd to disperse in fear. Boss music starts playing.

THE CHAMPION's Spin Top grows faster and faster until it transforms into a full-blown tornado.

RAV

What the heck is going on?

CHIDDY

The ref has to call off this battle!
This is insane!

REFEREE

What happens in the dish is fair ga-

Before the REFEREE could finish his thought, he loses grip of the bench he was grasping onto and gets sucked into the tornado.

BRIAN's Spin Top gets flown into the eye of the tornado and moments later, it comes out...disassembled into its base parts.

12 EXT. - THE PARK - DAY

The tornado shrinks, the weather turns back to normal, and the crowd, or what's left of the crowd, boos even harder than before at THE CHAMPION.

THE CHAMPION

Keep booing you babies, every breath
you take without my permission raises
my self-esteem.

BRIAN, tears forming in his eyes, makes his way through the crowd becoming out of sight. CHIDDY and RAV travel to multiple locations trying to find BRIAN until they see him sitting alone at a bench.

RAV
(sympathetically)
Are you over here?

BRIAN, laying backside on a bench, hands covering his face.

BRIAN
(somberly)
Yeah, to be alone. I've already
established the men's room doesn't
work.

RAV
You don't live far that far away? Why
don't you just walk home?

BRIAN
There are people everywhere. They'll
see me and pressure me to finish the
tournament.

CHIDDY
This tournament is getting out of
hand. We didn't know it was to the
death. We're sorry we didn't read the
full description on the poster when we
saw it.

BRIAN
You saw it... you just knew I wouldn't
care. But don't apologize, I got what
I deserved. I am a gross, unambiguous
teen with control issues who wanted
closure on a pointless memory that has
no effect on my future.

RAV
Let's get out of here. Who needs a
stupid glove anyways? It's not worth
our lives.

BRIAN
No. I will finish this tournament. I
am not walking out defeated from my
past.

BRIAN reassembles his broken Spin Top then starts marching
back to the dish feeling much better than before until CHIDDY
stops BRIAN.

CHIDDY

Brian, wait! I think you'll want this.

CHIDDY hands BRIAN a new Spin Top. This one looked similar to THE CHAMPION.

BRIAN

BRO, no way! How did you get this?!
They stopped making these parts the
year we were born.

CHIDDY

The day we were competing for that
Treatza in middle school. When I saw
you run off, I stole parts from that
turd when he wasn't looking. Now, go
win this tournament. Middle School
Brian is counting on you.

BRIAN nods confidently then runs off back disappearing into the crowd.

13 EXT. - THE PARK - DAY BUT WEATHER FLUCTUATES

THE CHAMPION notices the new Spin Top BRIAN is holding but plays off his worries.

THE CHAMPION

I see you have a new Spin Top now. Did
your turdhead friend give it to you?

BRIAN

(full of vengeance)
Don't call him that.

THE CHAMPION laughs menacingly.

THE CHAMPION

What are you going to do about it?

BRIAN

I'm going to beat you as I should have
five years ago.

THE CHAMPION walks up to the dish and removes his cloak.
Things are getting serious.

BRIAN and THE CHAMPION take their position on either end of the dish and prepare for the referee's cue. They begin.

BRIAN's Spin Top was clearly winning now. It seems CHIDDY's

Spin Top had an advantage over THE CHAMION's.

THE CHAMPION

I see your top has improved. Too bad
this isn't the game you remember.

THE CHAMPION nods to the REFEREE. He presses a button where the ground around the dish sections off and elevates. A pit of fire starts. The crowd, as well as CHIDDY & RAV, are in shock. The section tilts towards THE CHAMPION. THE CHAMPION laughs. The section tilts towards BRIAN. BRIAN slips and hangs off the edge, then pulls himself up. BRIAN's Spin Top is losing stability due to the various directions the platform is shifting.

THE CHAMPION laughs menacingly as his Spin Top transforms into the tornado we saw previously. It seems all hope is lost for BRIAN but just as he was about to accept defeat, BRIAN's Spin Top started transforming into its own tornado. It got bigger and bigger outgrowing THE CHAMPION's tornado. The weather got even harsher. Thunder was striking every second, it felt both freezing and blazing at the same time, and objects in the park were flying at such speeds into the two tornados. The Spin Tops break the dish causing an explosion which resulted in BRIAN and THE CHAMPION flying onto the ground.

As the dust cleared out and the players started to regain consciousness, we see one Spin Top still spinning and one shattered into a million pieces. The crowd, or what's left, abrupt into a cheer. RAV and CHIDDY pick BRIAN up. BRIAN had won the tournament.

14 EXT. - THE PARK - DAY

THE BOYS are now sitting at the same (and only) bench where they were enjoying their ice cream earlier.

BRIAN puts on THE POWER GLOVE.

BRIAN

Aww, yeah. So cool.

BRIAN releases his Spin Top and moves the glove around. The Spin Top doesn't move.

RAV

Dude, why isn't it doing the cool
tricks?

BRIAN
(panicking)
I don't know.

RAV
Did you type in the code?

BRIAN
yeah, I typed in the code. It's not
doing anything.

CHIDDY
I told you it wouldn't work.

BRIAN's Spin Top loses momentum and stops.

BRIAN
Dude, this glove blows.

FADE OUT

THE END